

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Theraplay Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Ages 0–12+ | Brain-Based Fit: Strong

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

Theraplay is a structured, relationship-focused play therapy where the therapist (and later the caregiver) leads playful, nurturing interactions that replicate the healthy parent-infant relationship. Unlike child-centered play therapy, Theraplay is adult-directed. It activates the social engagement system — the branch of the nervous system that supports connection rather than fight or flight. It provides the sensorimotor and co-regulation experiences that build the brain's capacity for self-regulation, and rebuilds attachment patterns through repeated experiences of attunement, playfulness, and nurture.

Caregiver Involvement:

Very high. Caregivers observe sessions initially, then are coached to take over the Theraplay activities. The goal is to transform the caregiver-child interactions at home.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child has attachment disruptions, difficulty trusting adults, or a history of relational trauma
- Your child is withdrawn, overly controlling, or has difficulty accepting nurture or comfort
- Your child is young or has developmental delays that make talk-based therapy difficult
- You want to specifically strengthen the caregiver-child bond

Brain-Based Consideration

:Theraplay's sensorimotor, relationship-based approach works well for children whose brains respond better to "bottom-up" (body and relationship) than "top-down" (thinking and reasoning) interventions. Because it doesn't require verbal processing or insight, it's accessible to children with cognitive differences. The adult-directed structure also provides the predictability that many children with brain-based differences need.

1. Is what is written accurate?

☐

Yes

☐

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Theraplay?



Thank you for your feedback!